Examples and Sources

Five fictional projects show how the same planning tools change with the product. These are original teaching examples, not real customers, manufacturer quotes, benchmarks or successful campaigns.

Use an example to make a decision

Choose the closest category, then replace the assumptions with your own product evidence and written quotes. The workbook starts with the fictional Harbor Council example. The other paths explain which costs, proof and delivery steps need different treatment.

The MOQ calculation

For a Kickstarter US $35 reward with 5% platform and 3% plus $0.30 processing, net campaign receipts are $31.90 per collected pledge. Subtracting $14 manufacturing and $3 other cost gives a simple $14.90 contribution. Dividing $6,000 fixed work by that margin suggests 403 backers.

The factory requires 500 units. At 403 backers, net receipts are $12,855.70, while $6,000 fixed work, $7,000 manufacturing and $1,209 other costs total $14,209. The gap is $1,353.30. At 450 backers, net receipts of $14,355 barely exceed $14,350 costs. Fifty units remain in stock, not in cash.

This illustration excludes shipping, failed payments, taxes, refunds, marketing uncertainty and contingency. It shows why the real goal needs a complete delivery budget and a cash calendar.

Rules for the examples

An estimate is an estimate. A quote needs scope, date, currency and expiry. A positive contribution does not fund the MOQ automatically. Later collections cannot finance earlier payments. Proof should show the actual product state. No page, email or example should promise an outcome you cannot substantiate.

Board game example

Harbor Council

A fictional strategy game about negotiating trade promises. All details on this page are hypothetical.

Evidence before the pitch

Start with a real rules excerpt and one complete turn. Show the decision and its consequence. The audience is players who like negotiation, not everyone who likes board games.

Reward	What must be clear
Core reward	One base game with the exact listed components
Bundle	Two base games; check the larger parcel quote
Digital	Print and play files with a clear personal use license

Cost and delivery decisions

Build a component BOM, including rulebook, insert, packaging and spare parts. Obtain MOQ and landed price per complete base game. Record a packed sample weight and the shipping quote by destination.

A mistake to catch

Do not announce a stretch component until you calculate its cost for every eligible backer, tooling, freight and packout. More pledges can create more obligations.

Next practical action

Show the current prototype and label renders. Record playtest issues, the rules version, and the remaining approval steps.

Card game example

Pocket Rivals

A fictional compact card game for quick sessions. All details on this page are hypothetical.

Evidence before the pitch

Show setup and a short turn. Demonstrate the actual choice in the game and publish the current rules. Verify the claimed player count and play time through testing.

Reward	What must be clear
Core reward	One deck with stated card count and stock
Bundle	Two or more decks with exact quantities
Language edition	A separate SKU only if its print run is fully costed

Cost and delivery decisions

Ask for card stock, finish, deck count, tuck box, seal, carton quantity, proof cost and print run price breaks. For a low priced reward, postage and fixed payment fees can materially change contribution.

A mistake to catch

A translated edition may have its own MOQ, editing cost and inventory. Do not divide one manufacturing quote across language variants that the supplier priced separately.

Next practical action

Compare an order of one deck with a bundle, including parcel size. A higher average pledge is useful only when the full reward and shipping still contribute.

TTRPG example

Ash Lantern

A fictional original adventure about a town that loses its shadows. All details on this page are hypothetical.

Evidence before the pitch

Offer an actual quickstart, sample spread or encounter. Explain the system, level range or standalone rules clearly. Record rights to text, art, fonts and licensed material.

Reward	What must be clear
Digital PDF	Accessible PDF and stated personal use license
Print edition	Printed book with dimensions and binding
Print and PDF	Both versions with clear delivery methods

Cost and delivery decisions

Budget writing, editing, development, layout, art and file accessibility as separate milestones. Obtain print proof, page count and binding quotes. Set zero physical units for a digital only reward.

A mistake to catch

A PDF has no physical postage or factory MOQ, but still has editorial and delivery costs. A print reward needs a complete separate print and parcel budget.

Next practical action

Test PDF download, links, reading order and device access. Name which sections are finished and who approves the final proof.

Miniatures example

Stonewatch Patrol

A fictional set of original fantasy figures. All details on this page are hypothetical.

Evidence before the pitch

Show a test print at the intended scale, including base dimensions and close details. State whether the reward is physical miniatures or STL files. A render is not a manufactured sample.

Reward	What must be clear
Physical set	Stated number of figures, material and bases
Digital STL	File list, supported or unsupported status and license
Larger set	Exact extra figures and the corresponding packout

Cost and delivery decisions

Separate sculpting and rights from master, mold, casting or print costs. Include support testing, failed prints, breakage, packaging and replacement stock. Obtain quotes for every physical variant.

A mistake to catch

A personal STL license does not imply commercial printing rights. State the actual license. Physical and digital rewards require different production and fulfillment steps.

Next practical action

Approve scale, fit, supports, orientation and visible quality before batch production. Test a packed parcel for transit damage.

Accessories example

Foldline Tray

A fictional modular dice tray for small tables. All details on this page are hypothetical.

Evidence before the pitch

Show dimensions, setup and a real fit test. Explain the material and intended use. Claim compatibility only where you have checked the relevant dimensions and conditions.

Reward	What must be clear
Core tray	One tray with stated material, size and finish
Pair	Two trays with exact colors or finishes
Optional insert	Separate add on only after tooling and fit are costed

Cost and delivery decisions

Quote material, tolerance, finish, tooling, sample approval, packaging and order increments. Color and finish choices can multiply SKUs and supplier minimums.

A mistake to catch

A new finish may require a separate minimum order and later delivery. Cost the variant before promising it as an unlocked option.

Next practical action

Record tolerance and fit acceptance, surface finish, wear testing and packout. Photograph the current sample and list remaining work.

First party sources

Checked 29 October 2026. Platform rules and provider terms can change. Open the current country specific page before committing to a price or a collection method.

Kickstarter funding and fees

Funding goal and budgeting: Kickstarter says the goal should cover the minimum needed to make the project and fulfill rewards. The campaign uses all or nothing funding.

https://www.kickstarter.com/help/handbook/funding

US fee defaults: 5% platform fee, with 3% plus $0.30 standard processing per pledge. Pledges under $10 use 5% plus $0.08 processing. Other countries differ.

https://www.kickstarter.com/help/fees?country=US

Shipping and taxes

Kickstarter Pledge Manager permits shipping at pledge time or collection later. Tax handling depends on the jurisdiction and setup. The workbook later fee inputs are illustrative and must be replaced with current provider terms.

https://start.kickstarter.com/pledge-manager-release-notes

https://updates.kickstarter.com/navigating-tax-collection-with-kickstarters-pledge-manager/

Promotion and responsibilities

Kickstarter offers custom referral tags before launch through Promotions. Use platform reported attribution without claiming that every delayed or cross device pledge can be identified.

https://updates.kickstarter.com/new-tools-to-help-creators-market-their-projects/

Present the product honestly, respect rights and backer privacy, explain AI use where required, and avoid unsolicited messages. Fulfillment contact details do not automatically become newsletter permission.

https://www.kickstarter.com/rules

https://legal.kickstarter.com/

Guildframe guides: https://guildframe.com/guides

Gamefound application notes

The workbook and briefs organize planning across platforms. The default fee calculation is a Kickstarter US example, not a Gamefound quote. Confirm the live settings and current terms for your project.

Fees and payment timing

Replace platform and payment fees, the small pledge threshold, later collection charges and payout timing. Set the small pledge threshold to zero when that fee tier does not apply. The starter assumes one collected transaction per pledge. Stretch Pay or another installment setup needs a separate dated payment and fee schedule.

https://help.gamefound.com/article/284-fees-for-projects-funded-on-gamefound

Choose the project type and phase

Crowdfunding, Express Crowdfunding, preorders and Store have different flows. Gamefound distinguishes Late Pledge from Pledge Manager: the former does not collect shipping details or shipping fees, while Pledge Manager handles that stage. Confirm supported regions, taxes and refund terms in your actual setup.

https://help.gamefound.com/article/285-getting-started-with-crowdfunding

Test rewards and page content

Use Gamefound Tester Mode to inspect rewards, phase visibility and test orders before launch. Follow the current editor guide; older projects can use a legacy editor. Match your creative exports and published sections to the editor and phase you actually use.

https://help.gamefound.com/article/366-tester-mode

https://help.gamefound.com/article/745-how-to-use-text-editor

Check the closing time before every reminder

Gamefound Endgame can extend the live countdown when late pledges or upgrades arrive. If enabled, describe the scheduled close and possible extension rather than promising an absolute final second. Recheck the campaign before sending a closing or funded email.

https://help.gamefound.com/article/434-endgame

Platform tools, requirements, approval, attribution and payment terms differ. A copied checklist does not confirm approval or make one platform rule apply to another.